

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 3
 ♥ 5 4
 ♦ Q 10 8 3
 ♣ J 9 6 5 2

♠ 8 5

♥ A K Q 8 7 2

♦ K 5 4

♣ A Q



♠ A K Q 10 7

♥ 10 9

♦ 9 7 2

♣ K 8 4

♠ J 6 4 2

♥ J 6 3

♦ A J 6

♣ 10 7 3

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♥

1 ♠

2 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

Lead: ♠ A

You are East. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠ A, West plays the ♠ 9, North the ♠ 5. You assume West has signaled you to continue ♠s, so you play the ♠ Q. On this trick West plays the ♠ 3 and North the ♠ 8. How will you continue?

You know that both West and North are now void of ♠s. You might just switch suits, but you have a better choice.

If you play your ♠ Q, West won't bother ruffing, North **WILL** ruff and dummy's ♠ J will be established as a winner.

The best procedure is to lead a low ♠. West will ruff and North will over-ruff but by playing this way you stop the establishment of South's ♠ J. As you can see, North would have been able to discard a loser on that ♠ J if you hadn't played this way.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 9 6 3
 ♥ Q J 10 7
 ♦ 8 5 2
 ♣ 8 3

♠ J 8

♥ 9 6 2

♦ K Q 10 9 4

♣ 9 7 5



♠ A 10 5 2
 ♥ 8 5 3
 ♦ A 7 3
 ♣ J 6 2

♠ Q 7 4

♥ A K 4

♦ J 6

♣ A K Q 10 4

West	North	East	South
			2NT

Pass 3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥Q

he started with three. A little bit of counting tells you that South started with the doubleton Jack, so you want to win the second ♦ trick.

This defense holds South to one ♦ tricks, if you had let him win the second one he would have had 9 tricks.

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥Q, you played low and South won the ♥A.

South now plays the ♦J on which West plays the ♦2. What do you play now, and what is your plan.

Play the ♦3 and when South plays another ♦ win with your ♦A.

North hoped his ♦ suit would provide enough tricks to make the game. You can see that there is no entry to the North hand EXCEPT in ♦s, so you want to win your ♦A on the trick that South plays his last ♦. How can you tell which trick that is?

Only by watching what West plays. On the ♦J West played the ♦2, a low card signaling that he held an ODD number of ♦s. ODD must be either one or three so when he followed to the next ♦ you know

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 7 2
 ♥ J 9 5 2
 ♦ A 8 4 3
 ♣ 8 3

♠ J 10 4
 ♥ A K 3
 ♦ J 10 9
 ♣ A K Q J



♠ A 6 5
 ♥ Q 10 6 4
 ♦ K 7 2
 ♣ 10 5 2

♠ K Q 9 3
 ♥ 8 7
 ♦ Q 6 5
 ♣ 9 7 6 4

West	North	East	South
	1♣	Pass	1♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♥4			

You are East. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥4, West plays the ♥J, won by North with ♥A.

North plays the ♠J, you follow with ♠5, dummy ♠3 and West plays the ♠2. North continues with the ♠10

Play the ♠6.

West's ♠2 tells you he had an ODD number of ♠s, obviously 3. Since North also must have 3, you must take your ♠A on the third round, depriving dummy of the extra ♠ trick.

North may now turn to the ♦ suit, but your side can win the first ♦ and drive out North's ♥K. You will win 2 ♥s, 2 ♦s and the ♠A, down 1

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 4
 ♥ A 8 7 5 2
 ♦ 7 5 2
 ♣ 6 4 2

♠ K J 6

♥ J 10 6 3

♦ A Q 6

♣ Q 10 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 7 3 2

♥ —

♦ 10 9 8 4 3

♣ A K J 9

♠ A Q 10 5

♥ K Q 9 4

♦ K J

♣ 8 7 3

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT		1NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥5

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥5, dummy played the ♥10

Play the ♦3 (or the ♠2).

You really want West to lead a ♣ if he gets into the lead. If you discard the ♣9 West will surely get the message and will lead a ♣. BUT - you will only win 3 ♣ tricks. The ♣9 would have been the fourth winner.

So instead, play a low card in one of the other suits, say the ♦3.

South is one trick short and he sees he can easily get that trick in ♥s. So he plays a second ♥ from dummy and you now discard the ♠2. West takes the ♥A and he can see that you don't want him to lead a ♠ or a ♦. He deduces that you might like a ♣ so he plays his ♣2 and you win 4 tricks.

Board 5

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8
♥ A 10 9 7 6 3
♦ 9 7 5
♣ A 6 2

♠ A Q 10 9 4 2
♥ K 8 5
♦ A K
♣ Q 8



♠ 6 5 3
♥ 4
♦ J 8 6 4 2
♣ J 9 4 3

♠ K J 7
♥ Q J 2
♦ Q 10 3
♣ K 10 7 5

West	North	East	South
2♥	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by North			
Lead: ♥4			

You are East. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥4, West takes the ♥A and returns the ♥3. You ruff and then play what???

Play a low ♣.

Partner played the ♥3, a low card, for you to ruff. That means his re-entry, if he has one, is in the lower-ranking suit.

Partner takes the ♣A and gives you a second ♥ ruff.